

Data and Applications

Project Phase - 3

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Changes Made:

- We changed client_id attribute in the Case entity type from a primary key to foreign key referencing the client
- We added a foreign key called lawyer_assigned to replace the relationship lawyer (represents) client.
- We have changed the cardinality constraint of people_involved relation. It was earlier 1:n but we have corrected it to m:n as an operation can have multiple people involved.

Procedure to Convert ER diagram to Relational Model:

Strong Entities: Create a relation (table) for each strong entity. Include all the entity's simple attributes, using only the simple components of any composite attributes. Choose one of the entity's key attributes (or attribute set) as the primary key for the relation.

Multivalued Attribute: Create a new relation for the multivalued attribute. This relation must include the attribute itself (or its simple components in case of composite attribute) and the primary key of the entity it belongs to as a foreign key. The primary key of this new relation is the combination of the attribute and that foreign key.

Weak Entities: Create a relation for each weak entity. Add the primary key of the *owner* entity to this new relation as a foreign key. The primary key of the new relation is the combination of the owner's primary key and the weak entity's partial key.

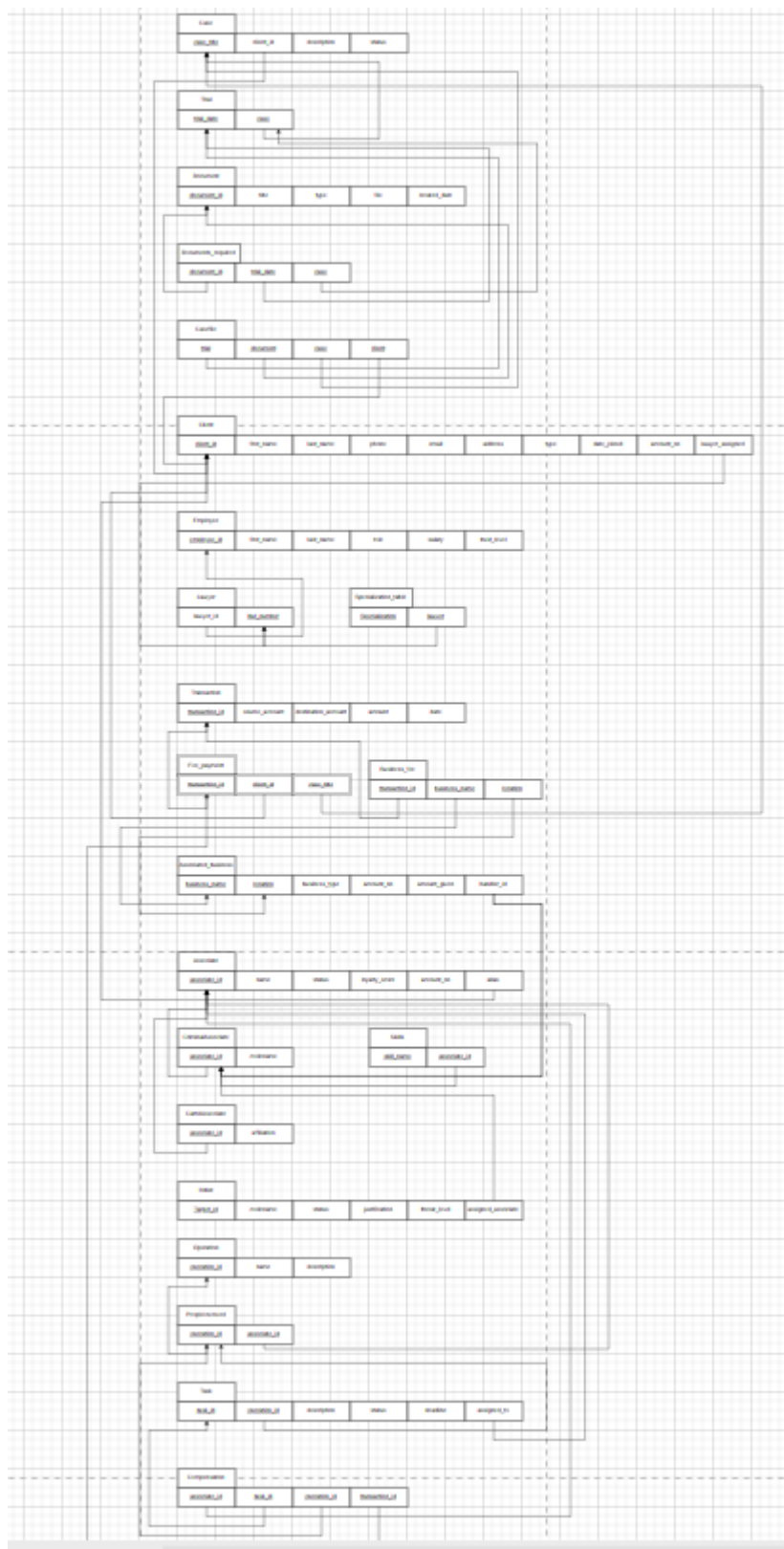
Binary 1:1 and 1:N Relationship Types: Most of them were converted to foreign keys. Sometimes we have to create a new relation that includes the primary keys of both

participating entities as foreign keys. The primary key would be a combination of both these foreign keys. Eg: Fee_payment and Business_fee were made as different tables.

Binary M:N Relationship Types: A new relation was made that includes the primary keys of both participating entities as foreign keys. The primary key would be a combination of both these foreign keys.

N-ary Relationship Types($N > 2$): Create a new relation to represent the relationship. Include the primary keys of all participating entities as foreign keys. Add any simple attributes from the relationship. The primary key of this new relation is typically the combination of all the included foreign keys.

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1NF:

Here each attribute can contain only atomic values. Since the procedure to convert ER diagram to relational model makes each attribute atomic, the relational model is already in 1NF.

2NF:

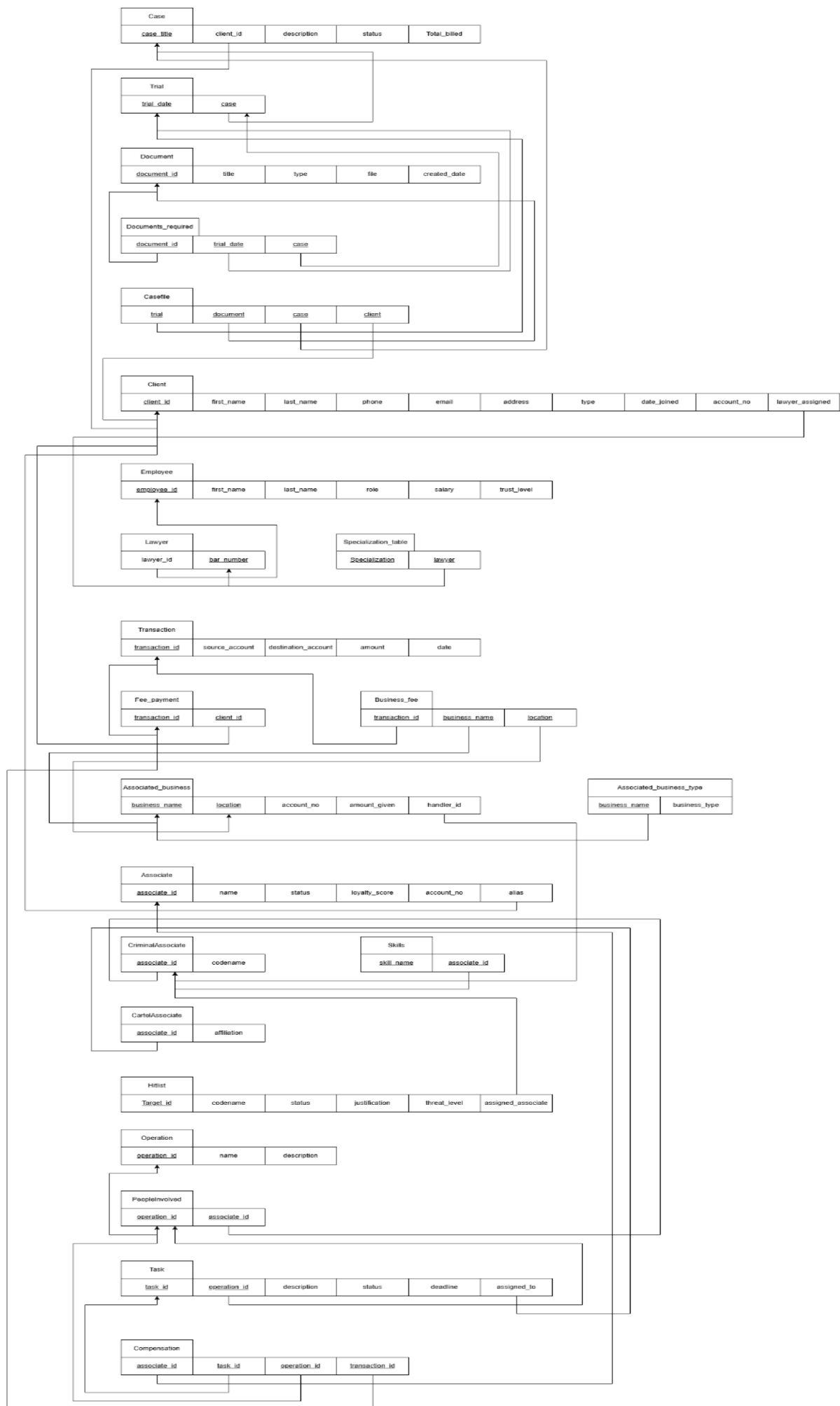
A relation schema R is in second normal form (2NF) if every non prime attribute A in R is not partially dependent on any key of R.

To convert from 1nf to 2nf, make new relation tables for FD's from a subset of a candidate key to non prime attributes, with the attributes it is dependent on as primary key. The elements on the right hand part of the dependency are removed from the original table. The elements on the left hand part of the dependency in the original table are foreign keys to the new table.

In Associated_business -> business_type is an FD. Hence it is separated into another relation.

Note account_no can be different for different locations of the same business, so its functionally dependent on both.

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3NF:

A relation schema R is in third normal form (3NF) if, whenever a nontrivial functional dependency $X \rightarrow A$ holds in R, either (a) X is a superkey of R, or (b) A is a prime attribute of R.

On finding a functional dependency from a non-key attribute to non-prime attribute, partition the table to create a new table with the elements of the dependency, having the left hand part of the dependency as the primary key. The elements on the right hand part of the dependency are removed from the original table. The elements on the left hand part of the dependency in the original table are foreign keys to the new table.

In the client table, attributes 'phone number', 'email' etc. may not be unique according to our DB. For example, people in a family may use common ones. Hence, it won't violate 3NF FD constraints.

In the associate_business table, multiple locations can have the same account number used for transactions/business. So, the account number attribute cannot be used to uniquely identify a tuple. Hence, it won't violate 3NF FD constraints.

One change we made is that we partition the associate table into 2 tables, as account id can also uniquely identify a tuple, so 3NF violation will occur as:

associate_id -> account_id -> non-key attributes (transitivity causes 3NF violation)

The new table we created (associate_account table) contains data related to the bank details (key being account number). This can be used to query account name, status, alias etc (attributes related to associate table).

Another change we made is that we partition the client table into 2 tables, as account id can also uniquely identify a tuple, so 3NF violation will occur as:

Client_id -> account_id -> non-key attributes (transitivity causes 3NF violation)

The table is split accordingly to remove the 3NF violation.

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